

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1960 CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION

Preparation of the 11th Consultation

Combating discrimination in education

Eleventh consultation of Member States on the application of the Convention and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960) (2024-2025)

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1960 CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION

1. Introduction

The Convention against Discrimination in Education (“the Convention”) and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (“the Recommendation”), adopted by UNESCO’s General Conference in 1960, are aligned with UNESCO’s constitutional mandate to “advance the ideal of equality of educational opportunities without regard to race, sex or any distinctions, economic or social”. The Convention is the first legally binding international instrument focused on the right to education and the only one exclusively dedicated to it.

The right to education is one of the key principles underpinning the Education 2030 agenda and Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4) adopted by the international community in 2015. SDG 4 seeks to ensure the full enjoyment of the right to education as fundamental to achieving sustainable development. Its scope captures the multidimensional nature of the right to education.

Representing a powerful tool to advance SDG 4 by ensuring effective articulation between normative and operational work, the Convention has been recognized as a cornerstone of Education 2030 agenda.

The present Guidelines are intended to assist Member States in the preparation of country reports on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation in the context of the 11th consultation.

2. Scope of the Consultation

Considering the Education 2030 agenda, the monitoring of the Convention and the Recommendation is of crucial importance to ensure an education that is truly inclusive for all and to counter persistent inequalities in access, participation and learning outcomes at all levels, particularly for the most vulnerable groups. This is particularly true under the current context in which countries are making efforts to recover from the learning disruption caused by the COVID-19 pandemic. Concrete measures taken by countries in accordance with their legal obligations under these instruments contribute to implementing the Education 2030 agenda.

As the scope and content of the legal obligations under the right to education are aligned with the 10 targets of SDG 4, efforts are being made to ensure that the components of the targets are included in the guidelines and that these guidelines serve as a valuable contribution to monitoring progress towards SDG 4 targets.

Beyond SDG 4, the Convention is also closely aligned with the normative content on the right to education of other international human rights instruments such as the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966), Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women (1979), the Convention on the Rights of the Child (1989) and the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (2006).

In addition, this Consultation is an opportunity to inform the ongoing **UNESCO Initiative on the Evolving Right to Education within a lifelong learning perspective**¹ (launched in December 2021). The Initiative investigates how the right to education could be reinforced placing it within a lifelong learning perspective and in light of the new demands being placed on education. This Initiative builds on the Report from the International Commission on the Futures of Education², which suggests broadening our understanding of the right to education to clearly apply it to all ages and across all times and spaces. The initiative is also in-line with the Vision Statement of the United Nations Secretary General on Transforming Education ³, and the Report on the 2022 Transforming Education Summit ⁴ which call for the transformation of education systems to ‘include everyone, regardless of circumstance, context or background’. The Initiative on the Evolving Right to Education aims to open a collaborative and participatory discussion about the international framework to ensure the effective enforcement of the right to education and learning throughout life for all. Finally, the Initiative builds on recent inter-governmental dialogues, including the Marrakech Framework for Action for Adult Learning and Education⁵ and the Tashkent Declaration on Early Childhood Care and Education.⁶

It is also important to note that previous consultations on the Convention and Recommendation revealed that countries now understand the right to education in an extended manner. The 11th consultation builds on the findings of the previous national reports to include various areas that have direct repercussions on the right to education such as, for instance, digital learning, climate considerations, lifelong learning entitlement, and the role of non-state actors in education.

3. Reporting obligations

There are differences in the legal nature of the obligations under the Convention, as distinguished from those under the Recommendation. The Convention has binding force, and the States Parties are under the obligation to incorporate its provisions into their domestic frameworks. The Recommendation, non-binding in nature, has political and moral force. Its adoption sought to take into account the difficulties that certain States might experience in ratifying the Convention, in particular with respect to their federal structure.

Bearing in mind the differences in legal scope inherent to the nature of these two categories of instruments, the content of the Recommendation is identical to that of the Convention. Member States are expected to give effect to it in national legislation and education policies.

The reporting obligation under the provisions of Article VII of the Convention and of the Recommendation is the same. Article VIII of UNESCO’s Constitution states that “Each Member State shall submit to the Organization, at such times and in such manner as shall be determined by the General Conference, reports on the laws, regulations and statistics relating to its educational, scientific and cultural institutions and activities, and on the action taken upon the recommendations and conventions referred to in Article IV,

paragraph 4". Therefore, even if a country is not a State Party to the Convention, it needs to submit a report on the implementation of the Recommendation, which means that all UNESCO Member States are expected to submit a national report on the implementation of these instruments in the context of monitoring consultations.¹

4. Participation in consultations

The reporting period for the 11th consultation on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation covers four years (2021-2024).

The Futures of Education Report calls for a new social contract for education, which requires to understand education as a common good and a shared societal endeavour. To ensure this, extensive consultations involving a broad range of stakeholders is needed. The reporting process therefore needs to be participatory. This includes ensuring cooperation between ministries of education and other ministries dealing with aspects of the right to education as well as consulting social partners and civil society organizations and other relevant bodies.

The preparation of national reports provides a good opportunity for Member States to assess the implementation of the right to education in their country, identify specific challenges, build constructive dialogue with other actors involved in this field and share good practices.

In the preparation of reports, Member States are encouraged to provide substantive and relevant information in a concise manner. In addition to a description of the constitutional, legislative, administrative, and policy framework established for the implementation of the provisions guaranteed by the instruments, the information supplied by Member States should demonstrate how legal norms and practices comply with the Convention and the Recommendation.

Relevant information supplied for other reporting instances may be reproduced or referred to with precise indication as to its retrieval. Similarly, hyperlinks to any useful documents or relevant legal and policy texts are most welcome and texts can also be added in the annex.

Country reports submitted for previous consultations can be found on the Observatory on the right to education⁷ in the monitoring section of the country profile. The information provided in the reports are valuable both for the Observatory on the right to education as well as for HerAtlas⁸, the online monitoring tool for girls' and women's right to education. Information and data regarding countries' education systems are also available through the UNESCO Institute for Statistics database⁹. Beyond monitoring purposes, the consultation findings and reports inform broader work - serving for knowledge generation, advocacy, and technical cooperation.

5. Modalities and structure

The Guidelines are structured around three chapters:

¹ <https://www.unesco.org/en/right-education/evolving> ² <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000379707> ³ https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/2022/09/sg_vision_statement_on_transforming_education.pdf ⁴ https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/report_on_the_2022_transforming_education_summit.pdf ⁵ Marrakech Framework for Action | Institute for Lifelong Learning (unesco.org) ⁶ Tashkent-declaration-ecce-2022.pdf (unesco.org)

- The first chapter covers general information on adherence to the Convention.
- The second chapter aims to gather information on the implementation of the Convention and Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4. As the most extensive part of the Guidelines, this chapter covers: inclusion and non-discrimination in education (section 1), all levels and forms of education (section 2), quality education provision and learning environment (section 3) and finally, strengthening governance systems (section 4).
- The third chapter seeks to obtain information on the methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments.

With a view to simplify the Guidelines while providing necessary substantive information to assist Member States in the preparation of responses, through a participatory process, two types of guidance are provided:²

- (1) Open-ended and closed-ended questions to be directly filled in by Member States. Please note that multiple answers may be provided where relevant.
- (2) Additional information aimed at guiding Member States to structure and detail their responses to the open-ended questions (including remarks on how to respond efficiently to the questions raised). These elements are presented in italics.

GENERAL INFORMATION:

Country name: **ITALY**

Organization or entity responsible for the preparation of the report: **Ministry of Education and Merit, General Directorate for students, inclusion and school orientation**

Name of contact person: **Manager Paola Deiana**

Email and telephone number of contact person: **+39 0658492425**

I. Ratification and applicability of the Convention against Discrimination in Education¹⁰

- Is your country a State Party to the Convention?

Xo Yes o No: Does your country plan to ratify this instrument?

o Yes: Please indicate the stage of ratification process reached by your country and whether assistance is needed:

² 7 <http://www.unesco.org/education/edurights/index.php?action=home&lng=en> 8 <https://en.unesco.org/education/girls-women-rights> 9 UIS Statistics (unesco.org)

- o There is interest but no concrete action has been taken
- o The ratification process has been initiated
- o The ratification process is close to completion

♣ Please briefly explain the steps that have been taken and timeline when relevant, any difficulties encountered (legal, institutional, political or practical) in completing the ratification process. And how UNESCO can assist:

o No, not considering ratification. Please explain why:

- Is the Convention directly applicable in your country's domestic law?

o Yes o No

- Have courts, tribunals and/or administrative authorities adjudicated on issues or violations regarding the right to education?¹¹

o No ³

o Yes: Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked?

o Yes o No

- Please cite the case law and jurisprudence.

Information could also be given about the judicial, administrative and other competent authorities having jurisdiction with respect to the right to education.

II. Information on the implementation of the Convention or Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4)

1. Towards an inclusive non-discriminatory education system

For reference: This section relates to the main purpose of the Convention/Recommendation that is to underscore the state obligation to proscribe any form of discrimination in education while promoting equality of educational opportunity as laid out in Articles/Paragraphs 1(1), 2 and 3 of the Convention/Recommendation.

It further corresponds to the overall aspiration of SDG4 which aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all” by 2030. While it covers all the SDG4 targets, it also specifically covers SDG target 4.5.12 –

³ 10 <https://www.unesco.org/en/legal-affairs/convention-against-discrimination-education> 11 Judicial mechanisms play an important role in enforcing the right to education by ensuring legal accountability and therefore contributing to the practical realization of the right to education.

-Please indicate whether the rights and principles laid out in the Convention/Recommendation informed the elaboration of the education legal and/or policy framework:

☐ Yes ☐ No

- If yes, please provide reference:

1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education

- Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation¹³, and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply):

For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b¹⁴

☐ Legal texts¹⁵ prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education:

☐ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)

☐ In primary education ☐ In secondary education

☐ In technical and vocational education and training ☐ In higher education

☐ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please indicate the relevant legal provisions:

See below 1.2

- Please list the prohibited grounds of discrimination in education as laid out in legal texts:

See below 1.2

☐ Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education

☐ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)

☐ In primary education ☐ In secondary education

☐ In technical and vocational education and training

⁴ 12 Which calls on states to “eliminate gender disparities in education and ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations”. 13 See: Article/Paragraph 1(1). 14 Which calls on states to “substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes”.

☐ In higher education ☐ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please provide details:

See below 1.2

☐ Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum:

☐ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)

☐ In primary education ☐ In secondary education

☐ In technical and vocational education and training

☐ In higher education ☐ In adult education and alternative learning

15 Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc.

- Please provide details:

☐ Other measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education:

See below

1.2 Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education

- Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (several items may be ticked):

General measures:

☐ Legislation provides for inclusive education for all

☐ Policy measures aim to enhance inclusion in education for all

☐ Teachers are trained on inclusive education¹⁶ and to value diversity

☐ Initiatives to address discrimination and promote cultural diversity and mutual acceptance

☐ Other:

☐ Multiple and flexible learning pathways¹⁷ are provided for

☐ Curricula and teaching methods are inclusive in design¹⁸

☐ Multilingual and intercultural education is supported

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

ACTIONS FOR THE RIGHT TO EDUCATION, CONTRAST SCHOOL DISPERSION AND ABANDONMENT, EDUCATIONAL POVERTY AND FOR ACCESS TO VOCATIONAL EDUCATION

(Ref. 1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education)

Student Card - " IoStudio " <https://iostudio.pubblica.editore.it/>

The MIM is committed to implementing measures and activities aimed at ensuring equity in access to training opportunities, promoting inclusive education and guaranteeing the right to quality education. In this regard, the Student Charter is one of the initiatives that aim at sustainable access to study and in general to the world of cultural services. Launched in the 2008/2009 school year, the service charter is distributed in schools to all requesting students from state secondary schools and those at the same level, in order to create the first inter-institutional partnership network to support the student's right to education, promoting access to culture through offers and structures in the field of cinema, museums, school materials, narrative, mobility, access to architectural and environmental heritage, study trips , support for the purchase of multimedia products audiovisual, telephony and Internet browsing, the use of technology to support learning.

Scholarships for the right to study <https://www.miur.gov.it/diritto-allo-studio>

Legislative decree 13 April 2017, n. 63, art. 9 established the Single Fund for the right to study aimed at combating school dropout which provides for the provision of scholarships for students at secondary schools. The Fund amounts to 39.7 million euros starting from 2019. The total beneficiaries in the 2022/23 year were **179,617**, equally distributed between males and females (86,953 females, 48%, 92664 males, 52%

Scholarships for the provision of textbooks
https://www.miur.gov.it/documents/20182/7975243/m_pi.AOOGABMI.Registro+Decreti%28R%29.0000254.22-12-2023.pdf/d265e8d6-502a-87dc-c104-9a86de073de5?version=1.0&t=1708511337563

Art. 27, law 23 December 1998, n. 448, *Amount needed to guarantee the total or partial free of charge of textbooks for pupils who fulfill compulsory education in possession of the required requirements as well as the supply of textbooks to be given on loan also to secondary school students, for a total of 133 million euros* for first and second grade secondary schools.

The following contributed to the sum:

- **Art. 1, paragraph 258 law 28 December 2015, n. 208, Provisions for the formation of the annual and multi-annual State budget (stability law 2016).** Paragraph 258. *To contribute to expenses incurred and not*

⁵ 16 Teachers are prepared to teach all student (beyond just students with disabilities), equipping them with knowledge, values and attitudes that permit every student to succeed. See: UNESCO policy paper: Inclusive teaching: preparing all teachers to teach all students, 2020, p.14.

17 Multiple and flexible learning pathways are 'entry points and re-entry points at all ages and all educational levels, strengthened links between formal and non-formal structures, and recognition, validation and accreditation of the knowledge, skills and competencies acquired through nonformal and informal education' (Education 2030 Framework for Action, para. 33). This may include student transfers between courses and institutions and diverse learning modalities (online, in-person, full-time, part-time, etc.) to respond to individual needs and interests.

18 In designing the curricula and teaching methods, care is given to ensure that all students are provided with an inclusive and supportive learning experience that offers them the opportunity to succeed whatever their background.

covered by contributions or public support of another nature for the purchase of textbooks and other educational content, including digital, relating to school education courses until the obligation is fulfilled of school education, 10 million euros for each of the years 2016, 2017 and 2018 is established at the Ministry of Education (then MIUR).

- **Art. 7, legislative decree 13 April 2017, n. 63, paragraph 4** Effectiveness of the right to study through the definition of services, in relation to personal services, with particular reference to conditions of hardship and instrumental services, as well as strengthening the student card, in accordance with article 1, paragraphs 180 and 181, letter f), of law 13 July 2015, n. 107 “To contribute to expenses incurred and not covered by contributions or public support of another nature for the purchase of textbooks and other educational content, including digital, relating to school education courses until the compulsory school education is fulfilled, the financial allocation of the fund referred to in article 1, paragraph 258, of the law 8 December 2015, n. 208, is increased by 10 million euros for each of the years 2019 and 2020. Plan for the distribution of funds intended for the supply of textbooks for pupils who fulfill compulsory schooling according to the distribution of less well-off pupils (ISEE and income).

The distribution of the 2024 resources took place with directorial decree prot. n. 309 of 02/16/2024.

[https://www.miur.gov.it/-/decreto-direttoriale-n-309-del-16-febbraio-2024#:~:text=309%20del%2016%20febbraio%202024,-Nota%20Prot.&text=Disbursement of%20funds%20to%20Regions%20per,12%2F1998%20e%20s.mi.\)](https://www.miur.gov.it/-/decreto-direttoriale-n-309-del-16-febbraio-2024#:~:text=309%20del%2016%20febbraio%202024,-Nota%20Prot.&text=Disbursement of%20funds%20to%20Regions%20per,12%2F1998%20e%20s.mi.))

Scholarships for victims of terrorism and organized crime

The MIM provides the resources specifically allocated for scholarships in favour of victims of terrorism and organized crime. The procedure for the recognition of these benefits, also intended for the children of victims of terrorism, organized crime and duty, is managed in cooperation with the Presidency of the Council of Ministers which identifies, annually and through a public competition based on qualifications, the beneficiary students to whom the Ministry provides the scholarship.

“Free to choose” Memorandum of Understanding was signed on 5 November 2019.

<https://www.miur.gov.it/-/liberi-di-scegliere-un-protocollo-per-dare-alternative-di-vita-ai-minori-provenienti-da-famiglie-della-criminalita-organita-the-minister-fioramonti>

with the aim of giving a concrete opportunity to minors from families involved in organized crime contexts. The document was signed by the Minister of Education, the Minister of Justice, the Minister for Equal Opportunities and the Family, the National Anti-Mafia and Anti-Terrorism Prosecutor, the Public Prosecutor at the Court of Reggio Calabria, the President of the Court for minors of Reggio Calabria, by the Public Prosecutor at the Juvenile Court of Reggio Calabria and by the President of Libera.

Actions after the Covid 19 epidemic

The Ministry of Education and Merit has dedicated a section of the home page to Covid 19

<https://www.editore.it/coronavirus/index.html> and <https://www.editore.it/coronavirus/norme.html>

The main actions undertaken to protect fundamental rights in our country can be found in the various bulletins published by the European Union Agency for Fundamental Rights (FRA), please refer to the following link:

https://fra.europa.eu/sites/default/files/fra_uploads/it_report_on_coronavirus_pandemic_june_2020.pdf

Summer School Plan

Since the 2020-21 school year (Circ. n.643 of 04.27.2021), the Ministry has launched the 510-million-euro summer plan, to allow students to recover sociality and strengthen learning, taking advantage of workshops to improve skills (for example Italian, Mathematics, Languages), educational activities focused on music, art, sport, digital, courses on legality and sustainability, on environmental protection.

An offer that represents a response to the difficulties that emerged during the pandemic, but which also intends to enhance the good practices and innovative experiences born during the emergency. The activities will be complementary and integrated with those organized by local authorities. The resources are dedicated above all to the most fragile areas of the country, particularly in the South.

The Plan aims to bring the school back to the centre of the community, creating spaces for strengthening skills and recovering relationships, working together with the territories and associations, promoting community educational pacts.

The Plan has also been re-proposed for the 2021-2022 school year (note **n.994 of 11 May 2022**), **with funding of 280 million euros to finance** art, music and sport workshops. Creative writing, mathematical games. Insights into the environment, energy saving, peace education.

With Notice no. 59369 of 31 May 2024 <https://pn20212027.editore.it/avvisi/piano-estate/>

has been issued which intends to expand and support the educational offer of schools with specific actions aimed at promoting initiatives for learning, aggregation, inclusion and sociability, especially during the period of summer suspension of lessons in school years 2023-2024 and 2024-2025. The notice is part of the actions envisaged by the specific objective ESO4.6 of the national program "School and skills" 2021-2027 and the interventions referred to in decree no. 72 of 11 April 2024 of the Minister of Education and Merit. The initiative is financed by the European Social Fund plus (ESF+) as part of the PN Scuola 21-27.

Actions for the Ukraine emergency

The Ministry immediately took action to support the thousands of students coming from Ukraine by providing a series of indications for their reception in schools. At the site: <https://www.editore.it/emergency-educativa-ucraina/> each school can find, in addition to ministerial documents which also provide useful information for evaluation, teaching materials and food for thought for reception, in addition to official news and stories from Ukrainian students.

Professional technical education

The MIM issued Decree no. 240 of 7 December 2023, concerning the national experimentation project relating to the establishment of the technological-professional training chain. This is an experiment that will be activated from the 2024-25 school year. <https://miur.gov.it/editore-e-formazione-professionale>

The national experimentation plan is aimed at verifying the effectiveness of the design of an integrated training offer in the technological-professional field, capable of guaranteeing ample opportunities for choice of education and training within a supply chain that involves technical and professional institutes, training institutions accredited by the Regions pursuant to Chapter III of Legislative Decree no. 226/2005 and ITS Academy pursuant to law 15 July 2022, n. 99, at the same time providing for synergies with the business and professional system and enhancing the talents of students in order to combat the phenomenon of school dropout.

The experimentation involves the stipulation of a network agreement involving state and/or private educational institutions of technical and professional education, ITS Academy higher technological institutes referred to in law 15 July 2022, n. 99, training institutions accredited by the Regions, where present, also in partnership with universities, institutions of high artistic, musical and dance education, representatives of the reference production sector and of businesses and professions, other public and private entities.

The networks are established by agreement between Regions and Regional School Offices based on the priorities established by the programming of the training offer in relation to the characterization of the supply chain and the identification of the ITS Academy in their territorial area.

The shared and integrated training offer outlined by the subjects belonging to the network is linked to that of the multi-regional and multi-sector campuses.

The experimental four-year courses of technical and/or professional education ensure the teaching of all the disciplines envisaged by the reference curriculum, including the transversal teaching of civic education, pursuant to law 20 August 2019, n. 92, as well as the strengthening of STEM disciplines, through the use of didactic and organizational flexibility allowed by the autonomy of school institutions, laboratory teaching, the adoption of innovative methodologies, digital teaching and the use of all instrumental and professional resources available, within the limits of the autonomy staff.

The educational institutions belonging to the network undertake to implement and strengthen stable relationships with companies and production entities in the area through one or more partnership agreements aimed at defining the methods of co-planning the training offer, implementing the PCTOs and stipulating the first and third level apprenticeships.

Starting from the 2024/2025 school year, the first classes of the four-year experimental technical and professional education courses authorized following acceptance of the application as well as the courses provided by the training institutions accredited by the Regions selected by the Regions are activated.

The ITS Academies participating in the network initiate, based on the integrated training offer and taking into account the specific needs identified and the productive vocations of the territory, suitable interventions for the benefit of students, in close synergy with the orientation initiatives.

At the end of the first experimental cycle, including the secondary education and training path and the tertiary education path in the ITS Academy, the experimentation may be renewed, subject to a positive evaluation by the National Observatory for Technical and Professional Education.

<https://www.miur.gov.it/-/observatorio-nazionale-per-l-editore-tecnica-e-professionale-pubblicato-il-decreto-ministeriale-concernente-le-modalita-di-facciameto>

- In general, what challenges were encountered in the implementation of non-discrimination and equal opportunities principles in education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality

Xo Legislation provides for gender equality in education

Xo Policy measures aim to enhance gender equality

Xo Gender-responsive education sector planning is undertaken

Xo Providing positive or affirmative action measures

o Providing financial incentives and fellowships

Xo Teachers are trained (initial and in-service) on gender equality

Xo Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation¹⁹

o Other:

Xo All barriers for pregnant girls and young mothers in education are eliminated to ensure the continuity of their education

o Re-entry programmes for young mothers are provided for

Xo Ensuring safe and adequate gender-sensitive sanitation facilities²⁰

Xo Curricula are rid of all stereotypes²¹ and bias o Ensuring gender parity in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM)

X o Ensuring gender parity in technical and vocational training education and training (TVET)

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

ACTIONS FOR EQUAL OPPORTUNITIES, EDUCATION OF RESPECT, FOR EQUALITY AND THE CONTRAST OF GENDER-BASED VIOLENCE, PARTICULARLY AGAINST WOMEN (rif. 3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms)

Equal Opportunities and Education for Respect <https://www.miur.gov.it/-/liberi-di-scegliere-un-protocollo-per-dare-alternative-di-vita-ai-minori-provenienti-da-famiglie-di-criminati> **from-families-of-organized-crime-minister-fioramonti**

In compliance with the provisions of paragraph 16 of article 1 of law 107 of 2015 which establishes that: *"The three-year plan of the training offer ensures the implementation of the principles of equal opportunities by promoting schools of all levels of education for the gender equality, the prevention of gender violence and any discrimination, in order to inform and raise awareness among students, teachers and parents on the issues indicated in article 5, paragraph 2, of the legislative decree of 14 August 2013, n. converted, with amendments, by law 15 October 2013, n. 11"* we point out:

National Guidelines adopted with note 5515 of 27.10.2017 *Educating respect: for equality between the sexes, prevention of gender violence and all forms of discrimination.* The Ministry of Education and Merit has promoted multiple initiatives aimed at schools, in compliance with the guidelines.

Each of them is aimed at affirming the Culture of Respect. In this broad sector, gender discrimination has particular importance as a separate issue or as part of a broader framework of combating all forms of oppression (e.g. bullying, racial or religious discrimination, etc.).

MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING n. 06 of 23/11/2023 between **the Minister for the family, birth rate and equal opportunities, the Minister of education and merit and the Minister of culture** having as its object "[Prevention and combating male violence against women and domestic violence - initiatives aimed at schools](#)".

With this agreement a series of actions will be implemented joint initiatives, aimed at students of first and second cycle schools on the topic of preventing and combating violence against women and domestic violence with the aim of spreading the values of mutual respect and gender equality, thus contributing to reducing discriminatory and violent attitudes and acquiring the necessary tools to recognize discrimination and violence against women and girls. A first initiative connected with the aforementioned protocol is the competition notice "[From a glance: films by students on violence against women](#)" DD n.26 of 02/26/2024 currently underway.

NOVEMBER 25 – International Day for the Elimination of Violence against Women

With resolution no. 54/134 of 17 December 1999, the United Nations General Assembly established 25 November as the International Day for the Elimination of Violence against Women. The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, in Objective 5, recommends "Achieving gender equality and empowering all women and girls", in fact gender equality is not only a fundamental human right, but the necessary condition for a fair and sustainable world. For equality and the fight against all forms of violence to be primary elements for the creation of an inclusive school, the Ministry of Education and Merit is constantly committed to the promotion and implementation of activities aimed at fighting all forms of violence and discrimination with the aim of stimulating new generations to a culture of mutual respect by valuing individual personalities.

In this regard, every year the Ministry, in view of November 25th, promotes initiatives to raise awareness, prevent and combat all forms of violence and discrimination.

For November 25, 2023, the MIM lit up red, to represent adherence to the anniversary. Furthermore, on that day, at the MIM headquarters, the Minister celebrated the anniversary with a [video message](#)

In this regard, greater information may be provided by the **General Directorate for organizational planning, innovation of administrative processes, communication and contracts.**

[Protocol between the MIM and the Ministry of Health renewed on 19/01/2022, prot. n. 0000001 "Protection of the right to health, study and inclusion"](#) which includes among the areas of intervention identified the "prevention of communicable diseases [...] through structural training activities; - the promotion of psycho-physical well-being, **also through interventions on the issues of reproductive health, affectivity and global education on relationships**; - prevention activities of the phenomenon of cyberbullying, against all forms of violence and discrimination;"

Observatory on the phenomenon of violence against women and domestic violence

The MIM participates in the Observatory established at the Department for Equal Opportunities of the Presidency of the Council of Ministers in implementation of the art. 5, paragraph 2bis of the Legislative

Decree of 14 August 2013, 93, converted with amendments to the law of 15 October 2013, 119 and established with the Ministerial Decree of 12 April 2022: *institutional initiatives and activities aimed at preventing and combating the phenomenon of violence against women and of domestic violence, also in implementation of the National Strategic Plan on male violence against women 2021.23 (articulated in 4 Axes -Prevention, Protection and support, Prosecute and punish, assistance and Promotion).* <https://www.pariopportunita.gov.it/it/news-e-media/news/archive/observatory-sul-fenomeno-della-violenza-nei-confronti-delle-donne-e-sulla-violenza-domestica-the-minister-bonetti-chairs-the-installation-meeting/>

Working group to combat violence against women with disabilities

The MIM, through the General Directorate for students, inclusion and school orientation, is included in the Group, established on 25 November 2025, which operates within the National Observatory on the condition of people with disabilities. The Group is currently involved in defining actions along three lines:

- *Accessibility of communication and information*
- *Minimum standards of anti-violence centers and shelters*
- *Guidelines on gender violence and training of operators.*

MIM-Carabinieri Memorandum of Understanding "*Increasing the culture of legality and awareness of the importance of safety among young people, promoting knowledge and respect for the rules*", renewed on 05/19/2022. Among the issues are gender violence, stalking and femicide.

“NOISIAMOPARI.IT” PORTAL (www.noisiamopari.it)

The portal was created to collect contributions, teaching materials and proposals for new training courses designed for male and female teachers, for students and for families, with the aim of starting activities to combat stereotypes and discrimination.

The portal is also a useful tool for sharing good practices proposed by educational institutions and associations participating in the Forums and institutional observatories established at the MIM.

MARCH 8 - International Women's Day

The day, commonly referred to as Women's Day , occurs on 8 March each year to remember both the social, political and economic achievements of women, and the discrimination and violence to which they have been subjected and still are, in all parts of the world. .

In addition to the aforementioned initiative organized on the occasion of "STEM Month", in view of March 8, schools of all levels, within their didactic and organizational autonomy, are invited to carry out an in-depth study of the issues related to gender equality and the fight against discrimination referred to in Article 3 of the Italian Constitution.

On the occasion of 8 March 2024, the Minister celebrated the anniversary with a [video message](#) .

March – STEM Month <https://www.miur.gov.it/-/8-marzo-giornata-internazionale-della-donna-il-mese-delle-stem-e-bando-di-concorso-steam-feminine-plural--1>

A field in which the Ministry has historically been involved is the breaking down of stereotypes according to which girls are better suited to social and humanistic subjects and boys to technical and scientific ones.

A good gender mainstreaming process in this case ensures that all people can choose what to study regardless of gender, freeing this choice from the influences of gender stereotypes. This also and above all means preventing segregation in the job market and in the careers of tomorrow.

The MIM, in collaboration with the Department of Equal Opportunities of the Presidency of the Council of Ministers, launches the "STEM Month" initiative every year in March with the aim of promoting these disciplines in schools of all levels and grade.

On the occasion of 8 March, International Women's Day, the STEM [competition: feminine plural is therefore launched](#), which intends to encourage a reflection on the presence of women in STEM disciplines, in order to encourage students equally to develop a critical reading prejudices and gender stereotypes regarding these subjects, as well as encouraging female students to study these subjects. The objective of the competition therefore falls within the priority field of respect education.

For the school year 2023/24, the fifth edition of the competition, which sees a motivated and growing participation of schools, has integrated the acronym into STEAM, including the field of art, to better give the opportunity to youth creativity to express itself.

The MIM, with decree no. 184 of 09/15/2023, adopted the "**Guidelines for STEM disciplines**" which implement the reform included in the **National Recovery and Resilience Plan** and contribute to achieving the objectives of the investment "**New skills and new languages**", with the aim of "**developing and strengthening STEM, digital and innovation skills in all school cycles, from nursery to secondary school, with the aim of encouraging enrollment in tertiary STEM curricula, in particular for women**" **Ministerial Decree of 12 April 2023, n. 65.**

The Guidelines document does not contain new content but focuses on indicating more effective teaching methodologies and strategies such as: laboratory skills, problem solving, cooperative learning, problem-based learning, etc. Information, awareness and training actions aimed at families can be promoted, in particular on the occasion of the celebration of the **International Day of Women and Girls in Science in school institutions, to encourage participation in study courses in STEM disciplines**, mainly among students and of female students, **overcoming gender stereotypes.**

Adoption decree:

<https://www.miur.gov.it/documents/20182/0/DM+184+del+15+settembre+2023.pdf/278712a8-19de-e28b-8938-6fa4610fb13a?version=1.0&t=1698173015248>

Guidelines:

<https://www.miur.gov.it/documents/20182/0/Linee+guida+STEM.pdf/2aa0b11f-7609-66ac-3fd8-2c6a03c80f77?version=1.0&t=1698173043586>

Action: New skills and new languages

<https://pnrr.editore.it/competenze/nuove-competenze-e-nuovi-linguaggi/>

May 17 - International Day against Homophobia, Biphobia and Transphobia

With the resolution of the European Parliament of 26 April 2007, the European Union declared 17 May the International Day against Homophobia and against any form of prejudicial attitude based on sexual orientation. The principles which inspire the day are those constitutive of both the European Union and

the Italian Constitution: respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms, equality between all citizens and non-discrimination.

The school is constantly committed to achieving real inclusion within itself capable of enhancing individual personalities and has the task of educating the new generations to combat all forms of violence and discrimination.

In view of this day, schools of all levels, within the scope of their didactic and organizational autonomy, are invited to carry out an in-depth study on issues related to the fight against discrimination and respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms.

For the school year 2023/2024 the Minister issued Circular no. 68924 of 17 May 2024

https://www.miur.gov.it/documents/20182/7975243/m_pi.AOOGABMI.REGISTRO+UFFICIALE%28U%29.0068924.17-05-2024.pdf/d7450c29-7e9b-c7a7-b522-34d90d8edb42?version=1.0&t=1715946686570

Active School. <https://www.sportesalute.eu/progettoscuolattiva.html>

Another series of measures that contribute to the promotion of the culture of respect and equal opportunities and the fight against violence and discrimination passes through sport, which is and must increasingly become a place for female participation at all levels. The Ministry has paid particular attention to the physical activity of boys and girls, also through specific actions to support teachers. The "**Class Sports**" initiative deserves particular mention, today **Scuola Attiva kids** and implemented by **Scuola Attiva Junior**, also achieved thanks to the contribution of CONI, which consists in the enhancement of physical education in primary school, as a tool for the promotion of correct lifestyles and values from a young age, thanks to the inclusion of the specialized figure of the **School Sports Tutor**. Over time there has been a constant increase in the participation of state schools, which has reached 70%. Furthermore, school sport brings with it a message of raising awareness among young people on the fight against violence against women, with the **#NoViolenzaControLeDonne campaign**. Since 2017, all athletes participating in the international student championships have taken to the field wearing a campaign symbol on their shirts. The initiative started in Palermo with the world orienteering championship.

Financial education as an important protective factor against economic violence

The Council of Ministers approved the **Competitiveness bill bill 674 chapter III (law 31 December 2009, n. 196 Accounting and public finance law)**, which includes financial education **in the teaching of civic education (L. n. 92 of 20 August 2019)**. In this way, from an interdisciplinary and transversal perspective, finance, savings and investment acquire centrality in the educational path, with the aim of making children aware citizens, capable of participating fully in the economic life of the country. To promote financial culture, the bill provides for forms of cooperation between institutional entities and entities with economic interests.

The Ministry of Education and Merit, in fact, **will define the guidelines for the study of financial education in schools**, in agreement with the Bank of Italy and Consob and after consulting the associations representing banking and financial operators and users. Furthermore, the MIM, the Bank of Italy and Consob will sign specific agreements to promote financial culture, respecting school autonomy.

October is Financial Education Month and the Committee for the planning and coordination of financial education activities (Edufin Committee), of which the Ministry of Education and Merit is a member, invites everyone to propose initiatives aimed at promoting development of financial, insurance and social security

culture. (www.quellocheconta.gov.it). The initiatives will be held from 1 to 31 October 2023 (World Savings Day) and will take place both online and in person, through different methods: conferences, webinars, cultural initiatives, seminars, shows, game days and training events aimed at adults, teenagers and children.

Memorandum of understanding between the Ministry of Education and Merit and the National Council of the Order of Psychologists - CNOP, signed on 20 March 2024 to promote the culture of health and well-being in upper secondary schools.

The agreement is aimed at preventing students' psycho-behavioural problems, strengthening project paths for the acquisition of personal skills for life and promoting psycho-relational well-being for all school subjects, as well as promoting the culture of respect for the person.

will be designed on an experimental basis to support schools in carrying out activities aimed at encouraging the overcoming of developmental fragilities, with particular reference to situations of social and cultural disadvantage which hinder the processes of socialization and participation in the life of the community. school community, with the aim also of preventing and combating violence and bullying.

The set of activities envisaged by the memorandum of understanding also find solid references in the field of transversal teaching of civic education (law no. 92/2019 and Ministerial Decree no. 35/2020 containing the *"Guidelines for teaching of civic education"*), in particular in the aspects concerning the *principles of solidarity, equality and respect for diversity* as fundamental elements *that support civil coexistence, the value of the rules of democratic life*, as well as the concepts of *legality and solidarity of action individual and social* .

"Relationship education – Project paths for schools" project, financed with 15 million euros from the POC funds for schools – skills and learning environments, i.e. of the PN "Schools and skills" 2021-2027. The project offers **secondary schools the opportunity**, within their autonomy, to activate 30 hours of student **discussion groups in extracurricular hours with the advice of psychologists** belonging to the Order of Psychologists and with a referring teacher. The **National Parents' Association Forum** has the role of harmonizing the project with improving comments from parents. The project, which was born in the wake of the 2017 *"Respect Education Guidelines"*, has an experimental nature and is dedicated to upper secondary schools. **At other school levels**, education on respect in relationships is part of **civic education** which is transversal and compulsory teaching (law no. 92 of 20 August 2019), of **which one of the objectives of the curriculum is: the student is aware that the principles of solidarity, equality and respect for diversity are the pillars that they support civil coexistence and favour the construction of a fair and sustainable future.**

Directive

<https://www.miur.gov.it/documents/20182/7414469/Direttiva+n.+83+del+24+novembre+2023.pdf/069fdaaa-8206-9d7f-37d5-3caa14dd7bfc?version=1.0&t=1700842704740>

(development of social and civic competence in matters of citizenship)

Human rights in the curriculum

The guidelines for teaching **civic education** (L. n. 92/2019), https://www.editore.it/education_civica/

established starting from the school year 2020-21, establish that it is compulsory from nursery school and across all disciplines, with a total time of 33 hours in the curriculum divided into **axes: the study of the Constitution, sustainable development, digital citizenship. Schools, in their autonomy, can plan the curricular contents deemed most suitable in relation to them.**

Guidelines for the right to study of pupils outside their family of origin
<https://www.miur.gov.it/documents/20182/2223566/LINEE+GUIDA+DIRITTO+ALLO+STUDIO+ALUNNI+FUORI+FAMIGLIA.pdf/96f7870e-9f30-5d8b-4133-c7b20c9c5351?t=1564667201466>

adopted on 11 December 2017 - still in force - signed between the Ministry of Education and Merit (then MIUR) and the Guarantor Authority for Children and Adolescents. The Guidelines are dedicated to all those students who find themselves, for various reasons, sometimes definitively and sometimes provisionally, outside their family of origin. These are therefore: girls and boys, girls and boys in foster care due to difficulties in their family of origin; pupils who are guests, temporarily, in the structures of protection systems (family communities, family homes, educational communities, socio-health communities) where there is no family foster care; unaccompanied foreign minors, an increasing phenomenon in the last three years; girls and boys subjected to provisions of the juvenile justice authority in the criminal field.

Three-year protocol to defend the rights of young people signed on 10 October 2018, <https://www.miur.gov.it/collaborazione-con-l-autorit%C3%A0-garante-per-l-associazione-el-agricoltura> the Ministry and the Guarantor Authority for Children and Adolescents for the implementation of joint initiatives aimed at:

- a) spread the culture of children's and adolescence's rights.
- b) guarantee the right to study of pupils outside their family of origin, as well as pupils and adopted pupils.
- c) spread the culture of mediation.
- d) develop proposals on the essential levels of performance regarding civil and social rights.
- e) promote the diffusion of the culture of legality.
- f) promote education for an informed use of digital and social media.

In preparation for the national seminar (at the international Didacta fair which took place in Florence in September 2019 - dissemination of illustrated brochures) dedicated to representatives for the integration of foreign students, adopted students and inclusion, meetings were held in-depth analysis of the Guidelines for adopted minors and unaccompanied foreign minors.

Protocol between the Ministry and UNICEF

<https://www.miur.gov.it/documents/20182/0/Protocollo+Intesa+MI-UNICEF-prot.n.1359.18-05-2022+%281%29.pdf/384d9894-46a3-7bfb-daec-451d1de87ff9?version=1.0&t=1655736246897> renewed

on 05-18-2022, to strengthen interventions aimed at giving greater information to students on their individual rights, but also to promote behavior that respects the principles of inclusion and prevention of all forms of discrimination and violence. The agreement includes the **"Children and Youth Friendly School" Project**

<https://www.miur.gov.it/-/unicef-una-scuola-amica-delle-bambine-dei-bambini-e-degli-adolescenti> born in 2010 with membership of more than 1,200 schools of all levels. The project is aimed at promoting knowledge and implementation of the Convention on the Rights of Children and Adolescents.

International Humanitarian Law competition organized by the **Italian Red Cross**, aimed at students in the third and fourth classes of secondary schools. The **"IHL Competition"** is among the activities of the Italian Red Cross included in the **three-year Memorandum of Understanding stipulated by the Association and the Ministry of Education and Merit** relating to the diffusion of the Fundamental Principles and Values of

the Movement, of International Humanitarian Law and of Human Rights. <https://cri.it/2024/05/11/terza-edizione-della-gara-nazionale-diu-della-croce-rossa-italiana/>

National seminar "*Didactic inter-actions: the 0-6 age group, minors outside their family of origin*", held in Rome on 10 December 2019. During the training day - intended for representatives of the regional school offices of the system integrated education 0-6 years, the inclusion of pupils with disabilities and the integration of foreign minors - work proposals were provided for the activity with children in nursery schools and nursery schools, with reference to the Convention of New York and the legislation on the integrated system 0/6 years. The initiative is part of the broader activity of disseminating knowledge of the Convention among professionals who work with minors, with the aim of making the rights of the Convention concrete and applied in daily practice.

Two booklets were presented: "*Illustrated compendium of the guidelines for the right to education of pupils outside their family of origin*"; "*Illustrated compendium of the guidelines for the right to study of adopted minors*" with the aim of promoting the dissemination of knowledge of the guidelines and with them of the practices that can facilitate the scholastic integration of pupils outside the family of origin and of adopted pupils. Both booklets can be downloaded at the following web address: <https://www.garanteassociazione.org/news/seminario-fuori-famiglia>.

Memorandum of Understanding with UNHCR (UN Office for Refugees)
<https://www.miur.gov.it/documents/20182/0/PROTOCOLLO+UNHCR+FIRMA+DIGITALE+ENG+.pdf/ddc183b3-9299-3175-ba05-4f2871e95515?version=1.0&t=1618313862650>

On 23 March 2021, the Ministry signed the renewal of the component of the National Observatory for the integration of foreign students and for intercultural education, which will be discussed in more detail later. The protocol is aimed at promoting awareness-raising initiatives in schools on the issues of international solidarity, integration and intercultural dialogue. For the implementation of this protocol, a technical-scientific committee coordinated by the DGSIOS was established. This committee has prepared a short video, with the participation of the Minister, aimed at publicizing **World Refugee Day (20 June)**. The video was previewed in the plenary meeting of the National Observatory for the integration of foreign students on 15 June 2021. Furthermore, also with the collaboration of the Observatory's working groups, for the 2021/2022 school year it is A specific training module for teachers was implemented, as well as online training for teachers on the topic of refugees through modules prepared by UNHCR.

Memorandum of understanding with the CAI (National Commission for international adoptions)
"Promote and strengthen school well-being, inclusion and promote the right to study of adopted student "
<https://www.miur.gov.it/-/diritto-to-the-study-of-students-and-adopted-students-1>

On 27 November 2021, the Ministry signed the agreement with which the parties undertake to research and experiment with ways of connecting and interacting to promote and develop collaborative initiatives, to facilitate the process of school inclusion of pupils and adopted students. For the implementation of this protocol, a joint committee was set up with DD n. 2624 of 28 December 2021 and coordinated by the DGSIOS.

Guidelines to promote the right to study of pupils who have been adopted - 2023. The new ones were published on 28 March 2023 (prot.AOOGABMI n.5 of 03.28.2023), the result of the revision and updates carried out by the aforementioned Joint Committee.

Against racism

On 14 September 2017 the Ministry signed the **Memorandum of Understanding with the ATS Parole Ostili**, <https://www.miur.gov.it/documents/20182/0/PIMIUR+-+PAROLE+OSTILI.pdf/e3570f7f-748b-4c34-8f96-fa39476497ab?version=1.0&t=1505993772558> to promote a non-hostile Internet culture, aimed at greater awareness of the use of digital tools for the construction of a real right to digital citizenship. The objective is to jointly develop awareness-raising initiatives on the issues of non-hostile communication and the promotion of active and aware digital citizenship, through the creation of specific training sessions aimed at teachers, male and female students on the national territory.

To encourage the process of reflection on the topic of online hatred, the Ministry, in agreement with the Chamber of Deputies, has issued, for the 2017/2018 school year, the national competition notice "The Chamber and young people against the phenomena of hate", aimed at secondary schools.

Manifesto of non-hostile communication was presented, a civil exhortation to the responsible choice of words and on 14 May 2018 the book "Hostile words - 10 stories" was presented, an important project to raise awareness and education against the use of hostile words, online and offline.

The **fight against religious and racial discrimination**, <https://www.miur.gov.it/-/carta-di-intenti-tra-mim-e-unione-delle-comunita-ebraiche-italiane>

To combat racism and pursue education to respect differences, the MIM has promoted, in collaboration with the Union of Italian Jewish Communities (UCEI), initiatives and projects aimed at passing on and strengthening awareness of the Memory of Shoah and renew the memory of those events. In 2002, the **national competition "Young people remember the Shoah"** was announced, one of the Ministry's best practices aimed at encouraging young generations to study and research on the topic of the Shoah. <https://www.miur.gov.it/-/i-giovani-ricordano-la-shoah-xxii-editore-del-concorso-per-l-anno-scolastico-2023-24-1> The competition was aimed at students of the first and second cycle of education with the ultimate aim of promoting the study and in-depth study of the history of the Shoah, understood as a universal lesson to combat all forms of racism and discrimination. Since its inception, over 7,000 thousand schools have participated in the competition, for a total of over 300,000 thousand students. In the 2023/24 school year the Competition reached its XXII edition and like every year the winners were awarded at the Quirinale by the President of the Republic. Over the years, traveling exhibitions have been organized throughout the country, collecting the best works created by students over the various years. As regards the training of teachers, to date, training and refresher seminars have been held aimed at school staff for the dissemination of guidelines for the fight against anti-Semitism and national seminars for the **training of teachers** on related issues are planned. to the Holocaust it is Meetings with students entitled "Passing of the Witness: the memory of the Shoah by survivors of the active scholastic practices of scholastic institutions and places of education, in fact, is the best vehicle so that the lesson of the Shoah is not lost, but Indeed, let it be a warning against every form of persecution, religious but also gender based. We also note the creation of the **"School and Memory" portal** <https://www.scuolaememoria.it/site/it/home-page/>, dedicated to Holocaust education and designed with the aim of providing teachers, trainers and students with a useful information and training tool and to create a platform for exchanging the best practices in teaching about the Holocaust among schools across the national territory, so that schools feel involved and protagonists in teaching equality and in the fight against racism of all kinds. As part of the initiatives linked to the Italian Presidency of the International Holocaust Memorial Alliance (IHRA), which took place between March 2018 and March 2019, the conference "The innocent enemy. Hate speech in contemporary Europe". The meeting, which was held on 12 November 2018 at the Holocaust Memorial in Milan, had the aim of analyzing and describing the processes of incitement to hatred from various points of view: historical (the characteristics of anti-Semitic propaganda and discriminatory type from the

National Socialist regime to today), legal (pro- and no-hate rules and legislation), sociological and communication (the trivialization of hatred and the aspects linked to hate speech on the web) and educational-didactic (the indications to counter the spread of hate speech).

In 2021, the Joint Scientific Committee - foreseen by the **Memorandum of Understanding**, signed on 27 January 2021, between the Ministry of Education, the National Coordinator for combating anti-Semitism, the Presidency of the Council of Ministers and UCEI - Community Union Italian Jews – drafted the **“Guidelines for combating anti-Semitism” presented on 23 November 2022.** ([https://www.governo.it/sites/governo.it/files/documenti/documenti/Presidenza/NoAntisemitismo/StrategiaN national/LineeGuidaScuolaNoantisemitismo.pdf](https://www.governo.it/sites/governo.it/files/documenti/documenti/Presidenza/NoAntisemitismo/StrategiaN%20national/LineeGuidaScuolaNoantisemitismo.pdf)). In particular, the Guidelines aimed at supporting educational programs in schools to prevent and combat the phenomena of intolerance and racism, are divided into the following points:

- examination of the main forms of contemporary anti-Semitism, such as traditional Jewish anti-Semitism, neo-Nazi/neo-fascist anti-Semitism and Holocaust denial, hatred towards the State of Israel, prejudice of "Jewish power" on the economy and finance, hatred against Jews as such;
- indication of elements for the early identification of possible critical issues that could emerge in the school environment, such as conscious and unconscious prejudices, conspiracy theories and silenced mentality, trivialization and distortion of the Shoah;
- description of some curricular topics touching on various disciplines (including history, literature, geography, social sciences, religion, law) to be used in school teaching. In particular, issues and topics related to anti-Semitism belong to three conceptual nuclei and therefore to three training areas: 1) Constitution; 2) Sustainable Development; 3) Digital citizenship;
- suggestions regarding training courses and teaching methodologies to promote the fight against anti-Semitism;
- bibliographical references and links to documentation and materials useful for combating anti-Semitism.

To promote the dissemination of the Guidelines in the educational institutions of the first and second cycle of education, during the academic year 2022/23 and 2023/24, a series of regional training seminars intended for managers and teachers organized at the Regional School Offices.

- What challenges were encountered in achieving gender equality in and through education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

- Does the legal minimum age for marriage conform to international standards (18 years) 22:

6

⁶ 19 ‘ Stigmatisation is the act of treating someone or something unfairly by publicly disapproving of them’ (Cambridge Dictionary).

²⁰ ‘ Gender-sensitive sanitation includes clean, safe and separate toilets, with access to water and garbage disposal’ (UNGEI blog post, Gender-sensitive sanitation, 2018)

²¹ Stereotype is a set idea that people have about what someone or something is like, especially an idea that is wrong’ (Cambridge Dictionary).

²² Please note that according to the Joint general recommendation No. 31 of the Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women/general comment No. 18 of the Committee on the Rights of the Child on harmful practice, para. 20: “a marriage of a mature, capable child below 18 years of age may be allowed in exceptional circumstances, provided that

Xo Yes o No

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate the exceptions to the legal age of marriage as well as the absolute minimum age:

National minorities:

For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities.

Xo Legislation provides for the right to education of national minorities

Xo Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of national minorities

Xo Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities

Xo The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for national minorities

o Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by national minorities

Xo Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for national minorities o Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for national minorities

o Other²³:

Xo Teachers are trained on intercultural education

Xo Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation²⁴

Xo Multilingual and intercultural education are supported

o Native language instruction is ensured for national minorities

Xo Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for national minorities

o Curricula are rid of all stereotypes²⁵ and bias

the child is at least 16 years of age and that such decisions are made by a judge based on legitimate exceptional grounds defined by law and on the evidence of maturity, without deference to culture and tradition.”

23 Please see: UNESCO report ‘The right to education of minorities: Overview of States’ measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023.

24 Supra note 15. 25 Supra note 16.

Please note that child marriage is a discriminatory practice as often girls can marry at a younger age than boys. Child marriage violates the child’s right to education as they are more likely to drop out of school and children who are not in school are more likely to get married.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

INCLUSION AND INTEGRATION OF MINORITIES

On 11 December 2017, the ***Guidelines for the right to education of pupils outside their family of origin*** signed between the Ministry of Education and Merit (then MIUR) and the Guarantor Authority for Childhood and Adolescence. The Guidelines are dedicated to all those students who find themselves, for various reasons, sometimes definitively and sometimes provisionally, outside their family of origin. These are therefore: girls and boys, girls and boys in foster care due to difficulties in their family of origin; pupils who are guests, temporarily, in the structures of protection systems (family communities, family homes, educational communities, socio-health communities) where there is no family foster care; unaccompanied foreign minors, an increasing phenomenon in the last three years; girls and boys subjected to provisions of the juvenile justice authority in the criminal field.

The MIM collaborates on the **research " *Unaccompanied Foreign Minors (MSNA) and their transition to adulthood***

https://www.miur.gov.it/documents/20182/2223566/Concept+Note+it_21+Oct.pdf/ae5b580f-583d-1c82-8ef4-34d37c04f6a9?t=1564667198494 co-financed by UNICEF and UNHCR, with the collaboration of IOM and implemented by the implementing partner "ISMU Foundation".

The Research on Unaccompanied Foreign Minors intends to provide an analysis through which the current legal frameworks and policies in place can ensure a better transition of these Minors to adulthood and a positive inclusion in Italian society. The National Observatory for the integration of foreign students and for interculture of the General Directorate for students, inclusion and school orientation participated in the inter-institutional MSNA table - promoted and managed by CeSPI (Centre for International Policy Studies) - aimed at the research "First Report - Observatory of Unaccompanied Foreign Minors in Italy - 2020.

The Ministry of Education and Merit collaborates in the implementation of the **FAMI National Program 2021-2027 - Public notice "Interventions to strengthen the educational integration of pupils and students from third countries 2023-2026"**.

Public notice for the presentation of projects to be financed under the Asylum, Migration and Integration Fund 2021-2027 – Specific Objective 2. Legal migration and integration - Implementation measure 2.d) - Scope of application 2.h) - Intervention c) Inclusive education "Interventions to strengthen the educational integration of pupils and students from third countries 2023-2026"

<https://www.miur.gov.it/web/molise/-/programma-nazionale-fami-2021-2027-orecchio-pubblico-interventi-di-rafforzamento-dell-integration-scolastica-di-alunni-e-students-from-third-countries-2023-2>

Still within the FAMI projects, the DGSIOS of the MIM has been collaborating, since 2013, on the **"National program for the inclusion and integration of Roma, Sinti and Caminanti children"**, promoted, within the framework of the actions of the PON "Inclusion", by the Ministry of Labor and Social Policies, together with the Ministry of Health and the Istituto degli Innocenti. <https://www.miur.gov.it/integration-degli-alunni-rom-sinti-e-caminanti>

The project activities are present in the main metropolitan cities: Bari, Bologna, Catania, Florence, Genoa, Messina, Milan, Naples, Reggio Calabria, Rome, Turin and Venice.

The main objectives of the project are:

- improve the participation and school integration of Roma, Sinti and Caminanti minors, in particular those who attend primary and lower secondary schools;
- Caminanti pupils in teaching actions and training activities ;
- facilitate the access of minors and their families to health and social services;
- consolidate territorial governance;
- create a collaboration network between the cities that join the project.

For the years 2016/2020, the following national training projects have been launched in the field of protection of foreign minors in Italy or of ROM, Sinti Camminanti groups: for the years 2017/2019 the **FAMI project "Multi-year training plan for managers and teachers of schools with a high incidence of foreign students"**, with a loan of 4,000,000 euros, involving a total of 1000 school managers, 10,000 teachers and 2000 ATA staff units; for the years 2016/2020 the **FAMI project "MICSE - Mediator for interculture and social cohesion in Europe"**, with funding of 2,500,000 euros, to start and continue professional improvement and refresher courses, and three-year degree courses experimental for the role of cultural mediator.

In the year 2020/2021, 9,000 pupils were involved, of which 600 Roma and Sinti in 91 schools.

In this regard, reference is made to the project's intermediate evaluation report and the web page supporting this report: [https://www.minori.gov.it/it/minori/progetto-rsc-report-di-valuation-intermedia - 2019](https://www.minori.gov.it/it/minori/progetto-rsc-report-di-valuation-intermedia-2019)

1597 Project "Government actions and tools for the qualification of the school system in multicultural contexts" managed by the Ministry of Education is financed by the FAMI - Asylum, Migration and Integration Fund under the **specific Objective 2 Integration/Legal Migration – National Objective 3 Capacity building** was approved by the Responsible Authority in 2017 and concluded in 2022. The project was created to involve a total of: 2000 third country citizens; 1400 public operators who benefited from training or professional refresher services; 30 desks activated in the integration hub schools; 200 good practices on school integration identified; 90 educational institutions involved; 18 Regional School Offices involved; 19 training or professional refresher courses for operators; 4 annual reports dedicated to statistical data on pupils and students with non-Italian citizenship carried out; 5 in-depth thematic reports on pupils and students from third countries carried out; website of the project for the dissemination of good practices on school integration; digital tools. From the latest available surveys, 27 desks have been activated, 11 training interventions have been carried out, 3 annual reports, the fourth is about to be published, 5 thematic guides, digital information tools on integration, preparation of a dedicated website.

The Ministry of Education and Merit collaborates in the implementation of the **"National project for the inclusion and integration of Roma, Sinti and Caminanti children. 2021-2023"** which has the following objectives: improving school inclusion and educational success of RSC children and adolescents; combating school dropout of RSC children and adolescents; improving access to social and health services for RSC children and adolescents and their families; consolidation of multi-sectoral territorial governance; creation of a collaboration network between participating cities.

<https://www.progettonazionali.rsc.it/>

The MIM-DGSIOS collaborated with the non-governmental organization AMREF, component of the National Observatory for the integration of foreign students and for intercultural education, for the implementation of the national survey "Mediated Africa", how the media, including those for children,

describe Africa. The office also participated in the public presentation of the research, Rome, May 2021.
<https://www.Osservatorio.it/wp-content/uploads/2022/05/africa-mediata-2022-amref.pdf>

National observatory for the integration of foreign students and for intercultural education
<https://www.miur.gov.it/-/scuola-riparte-l-associazione-nazionale-per-l-integration-degli-alunni-stranieri>

The Observatory is a consultative body established in 2014 and gradually confirmed and renewed by successive Ministers. Among its tasks is to make proposals and indicate solutions, starting from the concrete experience and good practices of schools, for an adaptation of integration policies to the real needs of a multicultural school, in continuous transformation.

The Observatory is made up of school managers, representatives of bodies and associations involved in the area, research institutes and universities.

The work of the Observatory is organized into five thematic groups:

Working Group on Adult Training and Education,

Working group on school curricula in an intercultural perspective

Working group on schools in the urban suburbs,

Working group on teaching Italian as a second language and multilingualism,

Working group on Citizenship and new generations.

“Intercultural orientations – Ideas and proposals for the integration of pupils from migratory backgrounds”, <https://www.integramigranti.gov.it/AnteprimaPDF.aspx?id=3392>

of 17 March 2022, publication by the National Observatory for the integration of foreign students and intercultural education based at the MIM.

https://www.miur.gov.it/pubblicazioni/-/asset_publisher/6Ya1FS4E4QJw/content/orientamenti-interculturali

“ V National Plan of Action and Interventions for the protection of the rights and development of subjects of developmental age 2022-2023 Education, Equity, Empowerment ”
<https://famiglia.governo.it/media/2636/v-piano-nazionale-infanzia-e-agricoltura-gennaio-2022.pdf>

promoted by the Presidency of the Council of Ministers - Department for Family Policies, adopted by decree of the President of the Republic of 01/25/2022. The Plan aims to give priority - in the country's policies - to programs dedicated to children, girls and adolescents, and to maintain the commitments undertaken by Italy for the application and implementation of the UN Convention on the Rights of childhood and adolescence, approved in New York on 20 November 1989. The Ministry of Education and Merit (then MI) is among the institutions that participated in the drafting.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of minorities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Indigenous people:

o Legislation provides for the right to education of indigenous people

- o Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of indigenous people
- o Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities
- o The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for indigenous people
- o Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by indigenous people
- o Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for indigenous people
- o Other:
- o Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for indigenous people
- o Teachers are trained on intercultural education
- o Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation²⁶
- o Multilingual and intercultural education are supported o Native language instruction is ensured
- o Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for indigenous people
- o Curricula are rid of all stereotypes²⁷ and bias

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

See above

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of indigenous people? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations²⁸: ⁷

- o Legislation provides for their right to education
- o Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education
- o Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured
- o Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for

⁷ 26 Supra note 15. 27 Supra note 16. 28 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' (UNESCO report: The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2).

- o All administrative barriers to access education are removed
- o Alternative administrative procedures (placement tests, portfolio of evidence, etc.) to overcome administrative barriers²⁹ are provided for
- o Teachers are specifically trained to ensure their inclusion
- o Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation³⁰
- o Other:
- o Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for
- o Auxiliary assistance is provided
- o Multiple and flexible learning pathways³¹ are provided
- o Curricula are rid of all stereotypes³² and bias
- o Accelerated learning programmes are provided
- o Non-formal and/or alternative education programmes are provided
- o Language classes to newcomers are provided for
- o Multilingualism and intercultural education are encouraged

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

See above

- Have specific measures been adopted for climate displaced persons?

o Yes o No

- Please elaborate:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of migrants, refugees, asylum seekers, stateless persons and IDPs? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added. ⁸

⁸ 29 While lack of documentation (such as identity papers, birth certificates, residency permits, etc.) should not be an obstacle to access education, these can constitute a barrier to education See: UNESCO publication: Handbook on the right to education, 2018, p. 96.

³⁰ Supra note 15.

³¹ Supra note 13 ³² Supra note 16

People with disabilities:

Xo Legislation provides for their right to education

Xo Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education o Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured

o Special schools are used as resource centers to inclusive schools

N.B. In Italy there aren't Special schools

Xo Positive or affirmative action measures are provided

o Financial incentives and fellowships are provided

o Other

Xo Mainstream teachers are specifically trained on disabilities

Xo Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation³³

Xo Auxiliary assistance is provided

Xo Curricula and teaching and learning methods are adapted

Xo Curricula are rid of all stereotypes³⁴ and bias

Xo Education infrastructure and learning materials are adapted

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

ACTIONS FOR INCLUSION, PARTICULARLY OF PEOPLE WITH DISABILITIES

(rif. 1.2 Equal opportunities and inclusion in education)

School in hospital and home education <https://www.miur.gov.it/scuola-in-editore-e-editore-domiciliare>

Legislative decree 13 April 2017, n. 63, art.8 establishes that to guarantee the right to education of students hospitalized in hospitals, nursing and rehabilitation homes and the right to home education, the provision of services and of the necessary teaching tools, including digital and telematic ones.

The hospital school service, in addition to allowing continuity of studies, guarantees pupils, in the event of illness, the right to learn and learn in hospital or at home.

The main purpose of the activities carried out with school-age patients who are hospitalized is to help them undertake a cognitive, emotional and educational path that allows them to maintain links with their school life environment.

The school in the hospital therefore pursues a project of global protection of the hospitalized child/youth, who is taken "in charge", not only as a patient or simple student, but in an overall and shared way among

all the operators with whom he comes into contact, according to the principle of the therapeutic alliance. The service is active throughout the national territory.

The school-in-hospital service is present in 137 hospital facilities with 257 hospital sections spread across Italy.

In the 2021/2022 school year, 42,794 students took advantage of the hospital school service, mainly from nursery and primary schools and 4,390 from upper secondary schools with the help of 955 curricular teachers of which 547 full professorships and 408 partial professorships. Due to the health emergency, teaching activities also took place remotely. Approximately 10% are students of non-Italian nationality.

The **home education service** is provided to pupils enrolled in schools of all levels, who are subjected to home therapies which prevent them from attending school for a period of time of no less than 30 days (even non-continuously).

In the 2021/22 school year, 1,439 students used the service for a total of 101,262 hours of home education, of which 47,948 hours were provided remotely.

For both services, school in hospital and home education, as also reiterated in the **national guidelines (DM 461 of 6 June 2019)**, the teaching activity carried out is recognized by the school to which it belongs and is valid in all respects.

The national portal for hospital schooling and home education is located on the MIM infrastructure (<https://scuolaineditore.miur.gov.it/sio/>) which is constantly updated with news from the territories and any other useful information for schools and stakeholders. There is also a section dedicated to the SiO and ID electronic register (RESO) which is an application for managing the school registers of students studying in hospital and at home and which allows you to document the teaching and training activities that take place for hospital school and home education.

The RESO application, integrated with SIDI, was put into operation starting from 27 April 2020, on an experimental and non-mandatory basis for all hub schools, and then became available and used on an ordinary basis (always non-mandatory).

Supply of teaching aids for students with certified disabilities <https://www.miur.gov.it/acquistare-ausili-per-la-didattica-inclusiva>

The framework of actions aimed at supporting and promoting scholastic inclusion includes the allocation of 10 million euros per year for the 2021/2022, 2022/2023, 2023/2024 school years provided for by law no. 30 December 2020. 178, paragraph 962, for the purchase and maintenance of technical equipment and teaching aids referred to in article 13, paragraph 1, letter b), of law 5 February 1992, n. 104, and for the acquisition of services necessary for their best use, intended for educational institutions that welcome students with certified disabilities, with the aim of improving the effectiveness of educational and teaching proposals, through the use of instruments suitable to facilitate the learning of female students and students with disabilities, based on their specific educational needs.

The distribution of the resources envisaged by the aforementioned regulation is carried out annually in favour of the territorial support centres (reference educational institutions, identified by the UU.SS.RR. on a provincial basis, for consultancy and training to support the inclusion processes, for the development, diffusion and better use of aids, teaching aids and new technologies for disabilities), based on the number of pupils and students with disabilities attending schools in the provincial territories, according to the findings of the General Directorate for information systems and statistics from the Ministry of Education.

To identify the beneficiary educational institutions, and therefore the projects to be financed, the regional school offices will issue specific notices addressed to state and private educational institutions, so that they can present specific projects aimed at the purchase of subsidies and aids. for inclusive teaching, in line with the interventions identified in the individualized educational plans for pupils and students with disabilities.

Based on the projects that are eligible for financing following the tenders promoted by the regional school offices, the territorial support centres finally have the task of purchasing the teaching aids/assistances associated with the inclusive teaching projects and providing the related functional services. to promote the best use of aids and subsidies.

In implementation of the provisions of the aforementioned provision, 100% of the resources allocated for both the 2021/2022 and the 2022/2023 school years were distributed among the CTS. For the school year 2023/2024 we will proceed with the adoption of the new distribution decree, at the end of the three-year financing period, with the disbursement of the balance resources, following reporting.

As part of the implementation of the provisions of the above-mentioned regulation, the digitalisation, on a national scale, of the entire process was also carried out which includes participation in regional tenders for the acquisition of teaching aids/assistances for pupils and students with certified disability, from filling out the project sheet, including the choice of the suitable aid/aid, to the evaluation procedures of the projects presented and the approval of the rankings, to the creation of **the national registry of the teaching aids and aids purchased, registered on the platform created ad hoc "Tools and teaching aids for disabilities"**.

PEI (Individualized Education Plan) DI n. 153 of 08/01/2023, corrective to DI n. 182 of 12/29/2020

Ref. law 107/2015 and Legislative Decree 66/2017 <https://www.miur.gov.it/-/decreto-ministeriale-n-153-del-1-agosto-2023> Interministerial decree 182 of 29 December 2020 marks the entry into the scholastic world of the new national PEI model together with the new methods of assigning support measures for all students with disabilities and for all school cycles, from nursery school to secondary school. The new IEP is adopted starting from the 2021-2022 school year.

The PEI refers to the concept of the biopsychosocial perspective of the ICF, acronym for International Classification of Functioning, Disability and Health, an international standard instrument approved by the World Health Assembly for the description of health and disability in different sectors, including schools.

The cornerstone of the ICF is the **concept of functioning within society which reviews the meaning of the condition of disability, no longer limiting it only to the characteristics of the person who has a diagnosis of disability, but which recognizes disability as a condition also determined by contextual factors**, for example obstacles or barriers of that limit the full expression of an individual's potential. The new PEI, intended as an individualized planning tool, highlights:

- the concept of **educational co-responsibility**, i.e. the need for each student to be taken care of by all people within the school community who must be adequately trained on inclusion issues.
- the need to **observe the school context and indicate the facilitators and barriers present**. Based on the observation of the school context, the educational objectives, tools, strategies and methods that allow for the creation of an inclusive environment are defined.

The new PEI is based on **four main dimensions to be considered for the purposes of inclusion and educational** and educational planning:

1. **Dimension of Socialization and Interaction** both with the peer group and with adults
2. **Communication and Language Dimension** (comprehension and production)
3. **Dimension of personal autonomy and social autonomy and orientation**: these include global and fine motor skills and the visual, auditory and tactile sensory dimensions
4. **Cognitive, Neuropsychological and Learning Dimension**: refers to abilities relating to memory, intellect, spatio-temporal organisation, cognitive style, the ability to use and integrate skills to solve tasks and reading and writing skills, calculation, decoding of texts and messages.

For each of these dimensions, the objectives must be identified, the educational interventions to be implemented in terms of activities, strategies and tools to be used, the criteria and methods of verifying the achievement of the objectives.

Disability: Permanent observatory for school inclusion

In implementation of the art. 15, paragraph 1 of the legislative decree of 13 April 2017 n. 66, the Permanent Observatory for school inclusion was established at the Ministry of Education and Merit renewed with Ministerial Decree 163 of 05.27.2021 and in conjunction with the National Observatory on the condition of people with disabilities established by law of 3 March 2009, n. 18.

https://archivio.pubblica.editore.it/argomenti/handicap_new/associazione_presentazione.shtml

<https://www.Osservatoriodisabilita.gov.it/it/notizie/riunione-congiunta-dellassociazione-nazionale-sulla-conditione-di-vita-delle-persone-con-disabilita-e-dell-associazione-permanente-per-scholastic-inclusion/>

The Permanent Observatory for scholastic inclusion is a collegial body composed of the Technical-scientific Committee and the Council of Associations with functions related to the analysis, study and monitoring of issues relating to the scholastic inclusion of pupils and students with ascertained condition of disability in developmental age. The secretariat, with technical-administrative and organizational support functions for the Observatory's work, is in Office IV of the General Directorate for students, inclusion and school orientation.

Autism Help Desk

With the Ministerial Decree of 16 June 2015, n. 453, the Autism Desk service was established by the Ministry of Education and Merit.

The SpA is a service coordinated by school system figures, with consultancy and support tasks, to encourage cooperation between teachers, the exchange of good practices, experiences and knowledge.

With DPPR of 20-10-2021, n.89, the Notice was published regarding " *Strengthening of existing autism help desks and establishment of new help desks* " adopted pursuant to art. 3, paragraph 1, letter b) of Ministerial Decree n.48/2021 for the implementation by educational institutions of project initiatives aimed at strengthening and establishing new branches.

https://www.editore.it/coronavirus/allegati/presentazione_sportelli-aiuto.pdf

Renewal of the MIUR (now MIM) - UICI memorandum of understanding dated 17-02-2022

A Memorandum of Understanding has been established between the Ministry of Education and Merit and the Italian Union of the Blind and Visually Impaired (UICI) to " *Promote and guarantee adequate educational paths for pupils, pupils with visual disabilities and multiple every type and level of school.* "

The UICI as general national referent and coordinator of the institutions and multiple structures, in agreement with the MIM, respecting school autonomy and in synergy with the Regional School Offices, has identified and recognized lines of common action to develop a network of interventions aimed at

supporting scholastic inclusion in every phase and degree of visual disability: (absolutely blind, partially blind, visually impaired pursuant to law 138/2001, additional disabilities).

<https://www.miur.gov.it/-/protocollo-d-impresa-tra-ministero-dell-editore-e-uici-Unione-italiana-dei-ciechi-e-degli-ipovedenti>

TSI – 2022 EUROCH – IBA funded by the European Union and implemented by the European Agency for Special Needs and Inclusive Education, in collaboration with the European Commission to combat inequalities in access to inclusive education in Spain, Portugal, Italy https://reform-support.ec.europa.eu/our-projects/technical-support-instrument-2022-country-factsheets_en

DL 22 March 2021, n. 41, art. 34 ter *Measures for the recognition of Italian sign language and the inclusion of people with hearing disabilities*

Italian legislation has officially recognized LIS (Italian Sign Language) https://www.gazzettaufficio.it/atto/serie_generale/caricaarticleo?art.version=1&art.idGruppo=5&art.flagTipoarticleo=0&art.codiceRedazionale=21A03181&art.idarticle=34&art.idSottoarticle=3&art.idSottoarticle1=10&art.dataPubblicazioneGazzetta=2021-05-21&art.progressive=0

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of people with disabilities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Students from poor households:

- o Financial incentives and fellowships for school enrolment are provided
- o Transport, meals and education material are subsidised or provided free of charge beyond compulsory education
- o Positive or affirmative action measures are provided
- o Other:
- o Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation³⁵
- o Curricula are rid of all stereotypes³⁶ and bias

⁹

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

⁹ 33 Supra note 15.

³⁴ Supra note 16.

³⁵ Supra note 15.

³⁶ Supra note 16.

See above

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of students from poor households? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

See above

2. Progress made with respect to implementing the right to education across all levels and forms of education

2.1 Early childhood care and education

For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation³⁷ and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education³⁸. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked):

- ☐ Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are free
- ☐ Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are affordable
- ☐ ECCE services are accessible on a non-discriminatory basis
- ☐ ECCE services respect a child’s need for early cognitive and social development, foundational learning, responsive care, nutrition, health, safety, protection, and play. - Please elaborate further on the measures taken: - Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available?
- ☐ Pre-primary education is compulsory. Please provide the age of enrolment and duration: ¹⁰
- ☐ Pre-primary education is not compulsory.
- ☐ Pre-primary education is free of charge for all. Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is free:
- ☐ Pre-primary education is not free. - Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

¹⁰ 37 Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”. 38 Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE”

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education?

- o Limited access o Issues of equity and inclusion
- o Poor quality programmes
- o Other:
- o Poor learning outcomes o Low number of professionally trained educators
- o Lack of support to families

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

ACTIONS FOR THE 0-6 YEAR AGE GROUP

(Ref. 2.1 Early childhood care and education)

The integrated education and training system guarantees all girls and boys, from birth to six years, <https://www.editore.it/sistema-integrato-06/> equal opportunities to develop one's potential for relationships, autonomy, creativity and learning to overcome inequalities, territorial, economic, ethnic and cultural barriers (**Legislative Decree 65** of 2017).

With the ministerial decree of 22 November 2021, n. 334, https://www.istruzione.it/sistema-integrato-06/allegati/decreto_ministeriale_22_novembre_2021_n.334.pdf **zero-sei integrated system** https://www.istruzione.it/sistema-integrato-06/allegati/decreto_ministeriale_22_novembre_2021_n.334.pdf have been adopted , developed by the **National Commission for the Integrated Education and Instruction System** , established pursuant to article 10 of the **legislative decree of 13 April 2017, n. 65** .

Plan for nursery schools and nursery schools

Mission 4 – Component 1 – Investment 1.1 “**Plan for nurseries and nursery schools and early childhood education and care services** ” (announced on 2/12/2021 and the deadline for awarding the works extended to 20 June 2023)

Public notice **48047 of 2/12/2021** Mission 4 “Education and research” – Component 1 “Enhancement of the offer of education services: from nurseries to universities” – Investment 1.1 “Plan for nurseries and preschools and services of education and care for early childhood”.

The notice intends to increase the offer of educational services both for the 0-2 age group (nurseries) and for the 3-6 age group (preschools), thanks to the creation of new spaces or the safety of existing structures. 2.4 billion euros have been allocated for nursery schools and 600 million for nursery schools.

Added to the 3 billion PNRR resources are a further **108 million integrated by the Ministry of Education**, for a total of **3,108,496,490.50** euros which will finance **2,190 interventions: 333 for nursery schools and 1,857 for nursery schools and child care centres. childhood for the entire age group 0-6 years.**

Also, thanks to the Ministry's resources, a further 66 interventions were financed, including projects with equal scores.

In particular, 54.98% of the resources for nursery schools and 40.85% of those for nursery schools will go to the Southern regions. The additional allocation from the Ministry made it possible to finance: 19 more interventions with equal scores in the nursery school ranking and 18 more interventions with equal scores in the nursery schools ranking and, in the same ranking, a further 18 interventions in institutes of the South. It was also possible to finance a further 11 nursery school projects in the Southern regions, candidates following the reopening of the deadlines.

At the same time, the rankings of the 2021 public notice for 700 million on nurseries and multifunctional centers for the family were also arranged, which provides for the authorization of 234 new interventions for an amount of 381 million. This public notice contributes to the achievement of the PNRR targets relating to the activation of new places for educational services in the 0–6-year age group and is included among the so-called "existing projects" of the PNRR.

2.2 Primary and secondary education

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for universal primary and secondary education. In the context of the Education 2030 agenda, SDG target 4.1 calls on States to provide "12 years of free, publicly funded, inclusive, equitable, quality primary and secondary education – of which at least nine years are compulsory."

Primary education

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of primary education:

- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge?

o Primary education is compulsory

o Primary education is not compulsory.

o Primary education is free of charge.

o Primary education is not free.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education?

o Limited access o Issues of equity and inclusion

o High dropout rates o Poor quality programmes

o Other:

o Poor learning outcomes in: Foundation literacy Numeracy Social and emotional learning Others

o Disparity in learning outcomes o Low number of professionally trained teachers

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

Secondary education

In this part, please provide information on the general availability and accessibility to all of secondary education, including technical and vocational secondary education and training.

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of lower secondary education:

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of upper secondary education:

- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge?

o Lower secondary education is compulsory.

o Lower secondary education is not compulsory.

o Lower secondary education is free of charge.

o Lower secondary education is not free of charge.

o Upper secondary education is compulsory.

o Upper secondary education is not compulsory.

o Upper secondary education is free of charge

o Upper secondary education is not free of charge.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

- Please indicate whether the legal minimum age for employment is aligned with the end of compulsory education:

For reference: The employment laws and those related to compulsory education are interdependent and mutually reinforce each other. If the minimum age of employment is below that of compulsory education, the child is at risk of dropping out of school to work and therefore not completing compulsory education. On the other hand, if compulsory education is lower than the minimum age of employment, once the child has completed compulsory education, the door is open to child exploitation and the violation of labour laws.

Yes ☐ No ☐

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate how the provision is enforced:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education?

☐ Limited access ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion

☐ High dropout rates ☐ Poor quality programmes

☐ Other:

☐ Poor learning outcomes

☐ Low readiness of primary graduates

☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

2.3 Higher education

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.339, and target 4.440 . Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training.

- Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items may be ticked):

☐ Higher education is free of charge

☐ Higher education is accessible on the basis of individual capacity (as assessed by reference to relevant qualifications and experience)

☐ Higher education is accessible through financial incentives and scholarships

☐ Higher education is accessible through positive or affirmative action measures

☐ Higher education is accessible through credit transfer system between states

☐ Higher education allows for multiple and flexible learning pathways (flexible entry and re-entry, recognition, validation, and accreditation of knowledge and skills acquired through non-formal and informal education).

o Other:

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, university supplies, transport, accommodation). Brief quantitative information may be added.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education? ¹¹

o Limited access o Issues of equity and inclusion

o Poor quality programmes

o Poor learning outcomes

o Other:

o Low number of professionally trained professors

o Insufficient mechanisms to ensure smooth transition from secondary to tertiary

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.”

- Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items may be ticked):

o Provision of education for persons who have not received or completed the whole period of their primary education

o Provision of literacy programmes

¹¹ 39 Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”. 40 Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”.

- o Provision of continuous learning (such as learning programmes to develop knowledge, skills, abilities, or competencies for personal and professional development)
- o Provision of free of charge learning opportunities
- o Provision of professional training including reskilling and upskilling programmes
- o Recognition, validation and certification of non-formal and informal learning
- o Provision of free of charge career guidance and counselling
- o Lifelong learning entitlements including learning accounts, vouchers, etc.
- o Other:

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education?

- o Limited access
 - o Issues of equity and inclusion
 - o Poor quality programmes
 - o Other:
 - o Limited funding
 - o Poor learning outcomes
 - o Low number of professionally trained educators
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3. Quality education provision and learning environment

For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2, 4(b) and 5(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for quality education. Quality education is fundamental to achieve all targets of SDG4. It is also particularly highlighted in SDG target 4.a that recommends states to “build and upgrade education facilities that are child, disability and gender sensitive and provide safe, non-violent, inclusive and effective learning environments for all”.

3.1 General measures

- Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding:
- o State monitoring and inspections

o Health and sanitation o Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))

o Infrastructure

o Curriculum

o Student-teacher ratio

o School fees (if relevant)

o Other

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

You may include information on policies, protocols or codes of conduct.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education?

o Non-supportive or inadequate learning environments

o Violence in schools

o Cost of education o Conflicts or crises

o Other:

o Low quality educational infrastructure and materials

o Inadequate parental support to education

o Long distances to schools

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.2 Education personnel

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”.

- Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked):

o Teacher training is provided without discrimination.

- o Teachers' average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels).
- o Initial training and continuous professional development are provided.
- o Minimum standards and qualifications required for the teaching profession.
- o Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession.
- o Measures taken to promote diversity in the teaching workforce, including to redress gender imbalances at different levels of education.
- o Establishment of performance monitoring systems.
- o Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education.
- o Other:
 - Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:
 - What challenges were encountered in the education personnel?
- o Shortages of teaching staff
- o Lack of qualified, trained and motivated teaching staff
- o Lack of training centres
- o Other:
 - o Low quality educational infrastructure and materials
 - o High student – teacher ratio
- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms

For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.41 Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1.

- Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked):

See above

o Curriculum includes human rights education.

xo Educational and/or extracurricular activities are organized on human rights education.

o Other:

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken: ¹²

See above

3.4 Non-state actors in education

For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision⁴².

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked):

o Legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation⁴³ explicitly apply to non-state educational institutions.

Please specify:

o Policies aim to guarantee that the development of non-state education does not generate discrimination and that non-state actors offer a relevant alternative (without supplanting public education). Please specify:

o Legal provisions provide for the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children. Please specify:

o Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered:

o Registration o State monitoring and inspections

o Qualifications of teachers o Health and sanitation

o Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools)

o Infrastructure

o Curriculum o Student-teacher ratio o School fees o School closures

¹² 41 Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”.

o Other 42 Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors. 43 See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

- Please elaborate:

- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision?

o Low quality educational infrastructure and materials

o Low number of professionally trained teachers

o High student – teacher ratio

o Other:

o Issues in terms of equity and inclusion

o Weak government regulatory and monitoring capacity - Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.5 Digital education

Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion 44.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked):

o Digital technology use in education is provided for in the legal framework. Please indicate the relevant text and provisions:

xo Core legislations, policies, strategies or plans for the management, privacy, security, storage, transfer, use, and sharing of education data internally and externally to ensure the right to privacy of learners and education stakeholders (e.g., informed consent, transparent usage policies, etc.)

Xo Regulatory framework establishes minimum education standards for digital education to which all actors in education must comply.¹³

o Measures to remove barriers to accessing digital content⁴⁵, including ensuring access to curriculum aligned digital content available on free, public, multi-modal national platforms; high-quality content is available in core subjects, official national language(s), and designed with inclusive features to assist learners with disabilities.

¹³ 44 Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment.

Xo Digital skills incorporated into pre- and in-service teacher and leadership training curricula to create a culture of digital innovation and growth anchored in equity and inclusion that enables ongoing professional development for existing and emerging staff.

Xo Future-ready skills (including digital skills, data and AI competencies, critical thinking, etc.) integrated into formal curriculum at all levels of education

Xo Measures address the digital divide, including ensuring access to reliable electricity, meaningful internet connectivity at school and at home, devices suitable for learning and teaching, safe and sustainable software and secure platforms, and integrated education data systems.

o A well-established, sustainable, and cost-effective budget secured from a range of funding sources and intersectoral cooperation, supported by impact focused reporting linked to regional strategic goals.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

PROMOTION AND AWARENESS OF THE POSITIVE AND CONSCIOUS USE OF NEW TECHNOLOGIES AND THE FIGHT AGAINST BULLYING AND CYBERBULLYING <https://miur.gov.it/linee-guida-prevenzione-e-contrasto> (Rif. 3.5 Digital Education)

The most recent ongoing reform processes, aimed at promoting a new public interest in the recognition of the real primary rights of citizens in the digital space, most recently, the adoption of the Regulation of the European Parliament and of the Council, relating to the protection of natural persons with regarding the processing of personal data, in addition to the free movement of data (**GDPR 679/16**), see the Ministry committed to strengthening the main experiences and skills needed within its own administration, but also to society as a whole, thanks to the activities implemented as part of the European Better Internet for Kids strategy launched in 2012 by the European Commission. The Digital Agenda for Europe aims to bring all Europeans into the digital world, but for young people, Internet use presents particular needs and vulnerabilities that need to be addressed specifically. On 18 June 2017, **law 29 May 2017, n. 71**, "Provisions for the protection of minors for the prevention and fight against the phenomenon of cyberbullying". Subsequently, the "**Guidelines for preventing and combating cyberbullying**" were published , <https://miur.gov.it/web/guest/linee-guida-prevenzione-e-contrasto> conceived as a flexible and updatable tool to respond to the educational and pedagogical challenges linked to the constant evolution of new technologies, updated in 2021. The main actions carried out by DG Students find an appropriate place within this regulatory framework: the **Safer Internet Center project - Connected Generations, and the Elisa Platform, - L.71/ 2017**. The Guidelines were further updated on 18 February 2021 for the following two years, incorporating the necessary additions and changes provided for by the regulatory interventions, with particular reference to the innovations introduced by the aforementioned law of 29 May 2017 n. 71.

The Safer Internet Center

The **Safer Internet Center - Generazioni Connesse project**, which has contributed to making the programs implemented by the Ministry increasingly more qualified since 2012, is co-financed by the European Commission as part of the DIGITAL programme, member of a network promoted by the European Commission and which takes the form of online platform "Better Internet for Kids" managed by European Schoolnet, in close collaboration with INSAFE (network that brings together all the European SICs) and In hope (network that brings together all the European hotlines). The project is coordinated by MIM with the partnership of some of the main Italian companies dealing with network security: Guarantor Authority for Children and Adolescents, State Police, University of Florence and 'La Sapienza' of Rome, Save the Children

Italia, Telefono Azzurro, the EDI non-profit cooperative, Skuola.net. The Safer Internet Center (SIC) was created to provide information, advice and support to children, young people, parents, teachers and educators who have experiences, including problematic ones, relating to the Internet and to facilitate the reporting of illegal material online. The Project sought to develop services with an innovative and superior quality content, to guarantee them to move safely in the online "environment", considering, at the same time, the connected investment as a 'virtuous' opportunity for a 'social' and economic growth of the entire community. SIC is aimed at young generations, actively involving teachers, parents, bodies, associations and companies to make the internet a better and safer environment for both human and scholastic-professional growth, with actions that have brought (in)training tools to the field useful for promoting positive and critical use of the Internet and preventing possible uncomfortable situations. In particular, the main actions carried out are summarized below:

- **Online awareness activities: information and communication campaigns aimed at students, young people in general, teachers and parents.**

Cartoon videos and video tutorials were first produced through YouTube and social channels to make children, parents and educators in general reflect on the positive and conscious use of the internet:

<https://www.youtube.com/user/GenerazioniConnesse/> [playlists](#)

<https://www.facebook.com/generazioniconnesse/> <https://www.facebook.com/generazioniconnesse/>

<https://twitter.com/saferinternetit>

https://www.instagram.com/generazioni_connesse/

International Day of Online Safety, Safer Internet Day

Safer Internet Day (SID) is the world day for network security, established and promoted by the European Commission, which is celebrated on the second Tuesday of February. The objective of Safer Internet Day, which this year took place on 7 February 2023, was as always to conduct a reflection on the risks and opportunities of the Internet with the same protagonists of the school community, students, teachers, together with public stakeholders and private. Over the years it has become a reference event for all operators in the sector, institutions and civil society organisations, a factor made evident by the number of events now organized all over the world - calendar available on the European Commission website dedicated to the day : <https://www.saferinternetday.org/>.

- **Digital teaching in schools**

Development of an internal ePolicy through a new **platform for teacher training**. The platform supports teachers at every stage of the shared path, up to the return of the E-policy, a fundamental document for planning and/or updating digital education activities, as well as useful for identifying prevention actions for bullying and cyberbullying phenomena to be provided in the PTOF, as required by the regulatory provisions. The course is dedicated to primary and secondary schools and the school year. Starting from 2019-20 it is also extended to secondary schools.

- **Evaluation and monitoring**

The Project makes use of the scientific contribution and evaluation activities of the University of Florence and the University of Rome "La Sapienza" to carry out monitoring actions.

- **Youth Consultation Group**

Within the Safer Internet Center there is a youth consultation group that is constantly involved in the project's activities. The Youth Panel, made up of around 40 young people, has the task of disseminating the project activities and initiatives carried out, and is also an active protagonist of the activities by

producing information and awareness materials to give a voice to the young people themselves and promote their ideas and opinions.

- **Seminars for professionals**

Another activity planned within the Project is the creation of a cycle of 7 training and awareness seminars, dedicated to childhood professionals (social workers, paediatricians, psychologists, educators, teachers and school managers).

- **Listening and reporting lines for problems related to online activities**

The CEF - Telecom program provides, among other actions, the financial support of a Helpline for each co-financed project. Therefore, the Project envisages the strengthening of the SOS Il Telefono Azzurro (1.96.96) and the chat <http://www.azzurro.it/chat.html>. Among the actions of the Project, the strengthening of the two Hotlines, <http://www.azzurro.it/it/clicca-e-segnala> of SOS Il Telefono Azzurro and www.stop-it.it of Save the Children Italia Onlus, reserved to Internet users to report online the presence of child pornography and any type of illegal or potentially harmful content present on the web. The Hotlines are directly connected to the Postal Police, and it is possible to make anonymous reports.

- **Advisory Committee**

The SIC also makes use of a National Advisory Board, a working group that boasts excellent skills and know-how, thanks also to the presence, within a technical table, of the most authoritative subjects of telecommunications companies, ICT and of the web.

- **"Better Internet for Kids" policies - INTERNATIONAL CHARACTER SIC**

The Connected Generations project is also projected at the level of European Cooperation in synergy with other safer Internet Centers for the exchange of good practices, materials, educational and communication resources. The safer Internet Center English was actively illustrated in all the meetings planned by the European Commission: Safer Internet Forum and Insafe training meetings, aimed at promoting the exchange of good practices. Furthermore, all the activities described above were promoted as part of the #SaferInternet4EU campaign, launched by Commissioner Mariya Gabriel, as well as giving them visibility in a European and international context.

ELISA Platform Project - Training of referring teachers

With the issuing of the "Guidelines for actions to prevent and combat bullying and cyberbullying", and the subsequent "National Plan for the prevention of bullying and cyberbullying at school" presented in October 2016, the Ministry of Education wanted to give a strong signal of recovery of bullying and cyberbullying prevention activities, making specific financial resources available to schools to implement national initiatives, with the aim of involving as many educational institutions as possible and creating a national network aimed to combat youth hardship. Furthermore, as required by Law 71/2017 and the updates of the Guidelines for the prevention and combating of cyberbullying (MIUR notes prot. N. 5515 of 10/27/2017 and prot. n. 482 of 02/18/2021), the MIM is committed to implementing a **National Training Plan for reference teachers to combat bullying and cyberbullying**, requiring all schools and regional school offices to identify at least one reference teacher for bullying and cyberbullying. In fact, in collaboration with the Department of Educational, Language, Intercultural, Literature and Psychology Sciences of the University of Florence, the ELISA (E-learning of Teachers on Anti-bullying Strategies) platform was prepared and launched.) <https://www.piattaformaelisa.it/piattaforma-e-learning/> to equip schools with effective intervention tools on cyberbullying and bullying. To achieve this objective, two specific actions were carried out: an area dedicated to schools for online monitoring of bullying and cyberbullying and a section dedicated to teachers for training through modules and learning aimed at teachers.

Fund intended for the prevention and combating of the phenomenon of cyberbullying.

Through law 30 December 2021, n. 234 (article 1, paragraph 671) State budget forecast for the financial year 2022 and multi-year budget for the three-year period 2022-2024, a specific fund has been established at the Ministry of Education and Merit for the prevention and combating the phenomenon of cyberbullying.

The resources allocated were used through an allocation to the Regional School Offices, using as criteria the number of pupils, the degree of school dropout and the number of total cases of bullying/cyberbullying deduced from the results of the monitoring carried out through the "Elisa Platform" in collaboration with the University of Florence.

The Regional School Offices provided the contributions, aimed at implementing the projects, through the issuing of specific notices to identify the beneficiary educational institutions.

The intent is to support local actions aimed at combating the phenomenon of cyberbullying and raising awareness of the conscious use of the internet, educating students to be aware, across the various curricular disciplines, of the rights and duties connected to cyberbullying. use of technologies

With prot. Decree n. 1176 of 05/18/2022, the Administration has assigned to the Regional School Offices, to combat the phenomena of cyberbullying in schools, the sum of €2,000,000.00 following the provisions of art.1 paragraphs 671 and 672 of Law no. 234 of 30 December 2021.

With the law of 29 December 2022 n.197 State budget forecast for the financial year 2023 and multi-annual budget for the three-year period 2023-2025, the refinancing of the aforementioned fund equal to 2 million euros for each of the years 2023 was envisaged , 2024 and 2025.

We therefore proceeded to prepare a new departmental decree relating to the year 2023, issued with protocol. n. 513 of 26 April 2023 with which the overall financial resource, equal to €2,000,000.00, was distributed to the Regional School Offices based on the following parameters:

- number of students, for 40% of the total amount;
- degree of dispersion for 20% of the total amount;
- of cyberbullying cases (at least one case in the last 2-3 months) reported to the Elisa platform for 40% of the total amount.

For the current year 2024, the [departmental decree](#) for the distribution of funds to the Regional School Offices was issued on 12.02.2024 prot.n.256. The criteria adopted for the distribution of resources are the same as the previous decrees.

Considering the structural nature of the financial intervention, it was deemed appropriate to prepare tools for collecting data and information at the conclusion of the activities, to allow a systematic reading and analysis of the main results of the actions undertaken.

- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)?

- o Lack of quality, curriculum-aligned digital teaching and learning content that supports flexible learning and teaching pathways
- o Lack of equity and inclusion in digital learning solutions

- o inadequate safety measures and IT support to respond to issues of child online safety or reduce cyber security risks
- o Other:
- o Limited access to internet and/or electricity
- o Limited access to hardware (devices, chargers, etc.)
- o Difficulty in regulating the use of digital education solutions
- o Difficulty in sustainably financing digital education solutions at national scale
- o Lack of digital skills development for meaningful use of digital technology in teaching practice
- o Disjointed or fragmented solutions that are not centrally systematized or regulated

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added. ¹⁴

4 Strengthening governance systems

For reference: The Education 2030 Framework for Action states "to ensure quality education and conditions for effective education outcomes, governments should strengthen education systems by instituting and improving appropriate, effective and inclusive governance and accountability mechanisms; quality assurance; management information systems; transparent and effective financing procedures and mechanisms; and institutional management arrangements, as well as ensure that robust, timely and accessible data are available" (para. 18).

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked):

- o Monitoring mechanisms to assess compliance with the right to education obligations, including through management information systems.
- o Monitoring results are made public. Please provide the link:
- o Monitoring processes are participatory, inclusive and regular.
- o Sector-wide and multisector approach is adopted to education governance.
- o Financial resources are effectively allocated to prioritise the provision of free, quality, public education and are adequately budgeted for in government plans.
- o The decision-making process for the allocation of resources to education is transparent.

¹⁴ 45 Lack of internet connection, basic infrastructure or devices.

- o Ensuring crisis-sensitive and disaster risk-informed planning and programming, including the provision of quality education in emergencies.

- o There is a certain degree of decentralization in favour of local public authorities and autonomy for schools to ensure context relevance of their teaching.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance?

- o Budgetary constraints

- o Lack of involvement of relevant stakeholders and lack of cooperation/coordination at different levels

- o Absence of supportive/ inconsistent/obsolete legal and policy environment

- o Lack or weakness of monitoring systems – including the lack of reliable data

- o Poor dialogue with teachers' trade unions

- o Other:

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

III. Methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments

For reference: UNESCO governing bodies have underlined the need for awareness raising. Given the importance of normative action at the national level, wide dissemination of the Convention must be ensured, with the support of National Commissions for UNESCO.

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked)

- o Translation of the Convention/Recommendation into the national and possibly local languages

- o Dissemination and advocacy of the core content of the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education including through appropriate materials and resources

- o Activities undertaken or supported by the National Commission to promote non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities and to foster debate on critical issues in relation to the rights enshrined in the instruments

- Other: